SHERASONGWE PRIMARY SCHOOL

2026 PRIMARY SCHOOL LEAVING CERTIFICATE MOCK EXAMINATION

ENGLISH

(100 marks)

Time Allowed: 2 h 15 mins
8:00 am – 10:15 am

Name of Candidate: _____
(Surname First)

Name of School: _____

Instructions

1. **This paper contains 10 pages. Please check**
2. Write your **Name** and **Name of your School** in the spaces provided above and your **Examination Number** on top of each page of the question paper.
3. This paper consists of **4** sections: **A, B, C** and **D**.
4. You are expected to answer **one** question only from section **A**. Your composition should be between **100** and **150** words. You should answer **all** questions in Section **B, C** and **D.**
5. The **first 10 minutes** are for reading the questions and choosing the question to answer from Section **A**.
6. Write **all** your answers to the questions in sections **A, B** and **C** in the spaces provided on the question paper. In section **D** encircle the letter representing the right answer to each question.
7. In the table provided on this page, **tick** against the question number you have answered apart from questions **14** to **53**.
8. Hand in your question paper to the invigilator when time is called to stop writing.

Question Number	Tick Questions 1 – 13 if answered	Do not write in these columns	
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			
13			
14 - 53			

Turn over

Section A (30 marks)

Answer **one** question **only** from this section on the lined answer sheets on pages **3** and **4**. Write between **100** and **150** words.

EITHER

1. Imagine that one of your friends dropped out of school while still young to get married write a composition entitled **"THE DISADVANTAGES OF EARLY MARRIAGE"**. In your composition include the following points:

Paragraph 1

- the age at which the friend got married.
- the class he or she was in when he or she dropped out of school to get married.
- two reasons why he or she went into an early married.

Paragraph 2

- two problems that he or she is experiencing due to the early marriage.
- two things that he or she can do to solve the problems.

Paragraph 3

- two things that can be done to stop early marriages among the youth.

OR

2. Imagine that there is a problem of theft at the hospital near your school. As a head boy or head girl, you have been asked to speak to your fellow learners about it. Write a speech which will be represented during the assembly. In your speech, include the following:

Paragraph 1

- things which are being stolen
- time when these things are being stolen
- how many people are affected by the problem

Paragraph 2

- problems which people are facing because of the theft
- people who are involved in the theft
- how the thieve manage to steal these things

Paragraph 3

- two things that have been done to stop the theft
- two pieces of advice to the people on how they should take care of their property

continued/….

ANSWER SHEET

Continued/…

ANSWER SHEET

Continued/…

Section B: (20 marks)

3. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.

Khumalo walked home from school with his brother Maselera. It was Friday and they were looking forward to the weekend. Their uncle Bazuka promised to come and take them to the Lake. They looked forward to seeing Lake Malawi. Their friends at school admired them. They were all excited as it would be their first time to see the Lake.

When the day came, they woke up very early. Their parents told them to go back to sleep but they were busy preparing for the journey. They packed their bags, brushed their teeth and later had a bath. Their mother prepared a special breakfast for them. By the time they finished taking their breakfast, their uncle arrived. Are you ready to go? Uncle Bazuka asked them. "Yes! They responded.

They got into the car. Uncle Bazuka asked them to fasten their seat belts and started off. When they reached Dyeratu, Uncle Bazuka stopped the Car. He told them that they would buy some drinks while seeing Shire river. Maselera the eldest brother, said that he wanted to swim. Saying he had learnt it while at school. Uncle Bazuka allowed him to swim.

Maselera started swimming and he enjoyed himself and did not want to stop. His uncle called him to proceed with the journey. Instead of coming back, Maselera waved at them and went on swimming little did he know that the weather had changed. It was now windy when Maselera noticed the change of weather, he thought of returning. As much as he tried to return, the waves pushed him back. He was tired. He shouted for help.

Uncle Bazuka and Khumalo were worried. Uncle Bazuka rushed to a nearby Police station where he reported the incident. A group of Police officers came. Immediately they jumped into the water to look for him. After some minutes they found Maselera. He was tired and weak. They took him to the Police station where he was given some first aid. The Police officers asked them to rest for a day there. The following day they started off for the lake.

Questions

a. Where was Khumalo and his brother coming from on Friday?

_____

(1 mark)

b. Why were Khumalo and Maselera eagerly looking forward to the weekend?

_____

(2 marks)

c. Give **one** reason why Khumalo and his brother woke up very early on that day?

_____

(2 marks)

Continued/…

d. Why did friend's at school admire Khumalo and Maselera?

_____

(2 marks)

e. Mention any **two** things they did at Dyeratu?

_____

_____

(2 marks)

f. Why did Maselera shout as he swam?

_____

(2 marks)

g. Why did Maselera's uncle rush to a nearby Police station?

_____

_____

(2 marks)

h. How did the men manage to help Maselera?

_____

_____

(2 marks)

i. Give a reason why Maselera was given first aid.

_____

_____

(2 marks)

j. Find a word in

(i) **(paragraph 2)** of the passage that means "answered"

_____

(1 mark)

(ii) **(paragraph 4)** of the passage that means "continue"

_____

(1 mark)

k. Suggest the title for the story.

_____

(2 marks)

Section C (10 marks)

Change each of the following sentences from direct to indirect speech.

4. Direct: We saw the boys yesterday" said the teacher.
Indirect: _____

(1 mark)

5. Direct: "Let us assemble in the hall now," the teacher told the pupils.
Indirect: _____

(1 mark)

Continued/…

6. **Direct:** What is your name? The visitor asked.
   Indirect: _____
   (1 mark)

Change the following sentences from active to passive voice

7. **Active:** Was he eating Oranges?
   Passive: _____
   (1 mark)
8. **Active:** She has seen us.
   Passive: _____
   (1 mark)
9. **Active:** What they are doing is bad.
   Passive:_____
   (1 mark)

Make sentences using each of the following words to show that you know their meanings:

10. always
    _____
    _____

11. attract
    _____
    _____

12. any
    _____
    _____

13. extra
    _____
    _____

Section D (40 Marks)

Questions 14 to 26. In each of the following questions, choose the word or phrase (A, B, C or D) that best completes the sentences.

14. This bag is _____ than the other one.
    A. very heavy
    B. much heavier
    C. more heavier
    D. more heavy

Continued/…

15. If I wrote a letter today, I _____ post it tomorrow.
- A. Will
- B. Can
- C. Would
- D. Shall

16. Mr. Disuza congratulated his son _____ passing his Standard 8 examination.
- A. On
- B. For
- C. From
- D. At

17. We drink tea _____ a Cup.
- A. With
- B. From
- C. By
- D. In

18. Tamara is used to _____ up early every morning.
- A. Be getting
- B. Get
- C. Have been getting
- D. Getting

19. The train _____ Kanengo station fifteen minutes ahead of time.
- A. Reached at
- B. Arrived
- C. Reached
- D. Arrived in

20. When the minibus stopped at Lizulu, many passengers _____ to buy vegetables.
- A. Got off
- B. Got out
- C. Went out
- D. Went off

21. We will go to the party if chikondi _____ by 6:00 o'clock.
- A. Was in
- B. Would be in
- C. Is in
- D. Will be in

22. The subject I like _____ is English.
- A. More
- B. Most
- C. Much
- D. Better

23. Your suggestion_____ by the committee at that moment.
- A. Was discussed
- B. Is being discussed
- C. Is discussed
- D. Was being discussed

24. By the time he comes, his mother _____gone.
- A. Will have
- B. Would have
- C. Is
- D. Was

25. The thief was _____ those three fishermen.
- A. Between
- B. Within
- C. Inside
- D. Among

26. Soon, I will be leaving _____ Mulanje
- A. To
- B. From
- C. For
- D. At

EXAMINATION NO.:_____

Question 27 to 39. In each of the following questions, choose the correct part of speech (A, B, C or D) for each of the underlined words

27. Quickly! The police officer shouted.
- A. Adverb
- B. Conjunction
- C. Adjective
- D. Interjection

28. A head is a ditch, please take care.
- A. Noun
- B. Adverb
- C. Adjective
- D. Conjunction

29. Misheck walks like a soldier.
- A. Noun
- B. Verb
- C. Adverb
- D. Preposition

30. Should our team wins, we shall celebrate.
- A. Conjunction
- B. Adverb
- C. Adjective
- D. Verb

31. The wind blew the tree down.
- A. Noun
- B. Preposition
- C. Pronoun
- D. Adverb

32. I like eating ripe mangoes.
- A. Verb
- B. Noun
- C. Adverb
- D. Adjective

33. Tamanda is going to the school garden.
- A. Noun
- B. Adverb
- C. Preposition
- D. Adjective

34. We water vegetables every day.
- A. Verb
- B. Adjective
- C. Adverb
- D. Noun

35. Bafana Bafana players always like attacking football.
- A. Verb
- B. Adverb
- C. Preposition
- D. Adjective

36. Neither of the girls is present.
- A. Adjective
- B. Adverb
- C. Conjunction
- D. Pronoun

37. I heard a shout from our neighbour's house.
- A. Verb
- B. Preposition
- C. Noun
- D. Adjective

38. Mr. Gwaza's arrival at the airport excited us.
- A. Noun
- B. Adjective
- C. Adverb
- D. Pronoun

39. Mr. Phiri has gone home
- A. Noun
- B. Adjective
- C. Adverb
- D. Pronoun

Questions 40 to 44: in each of the following questions, Choose the correct question tag (A, B, C, or D) for the statement.

40. He's never seen a lion, _____?
A. Has he
B. Isn't he
C. Is he
D. Hasn't he

41. There are many students in the hall, _____?
A. Are there
B. Aren't there
C. Are they
D. Aren't they

42. Our examination will start next week, _____?
A. Won't they
B. Will it
C. Will they
D. Won't it

43. Give me that pen, _____?
A. Shall we
B. Shan't we
C. Will you
D. Won't you

44. We ran to school this morning _____?
A. Don't we
B. Didn't we
C. Did we
D. Do we

Question 45 and 46. In each of the following questions choose the word (A, B, C or D) that best completes the proverbs.

45. You can lead a _____ to a river but you can't force it to drink.
A. Horse
B. Camel
C. Dog
D. Goat

46. She was born with a silver _____ in the mouth.
A. Folk
B. Saucer
C. Cup
D. Spoon

Questions 47 and 48: in each of the following questions, choose the word (A, B, C or D) that best completes the similes

47. As _____ as a church mouse.
A. Clever
B. Poor
C. Shy
D. Quite

48. As _____ as a morning star.
A. Shiny
B. Light
C. Clear
D. Bright

Question 49 to 53, In each of the following questions, choose the answer (A, B, C or D) that gives the correct type of clause and its function. The clause has been underlined.

49. Bake this cake <u>as I do</u>.
A. Adjective clause, qualilfying "cake"
B. Noun clause in apposition to "cake"
C. Adverb clause, modifying "bake"
D. Noun clause, object of "cake"

50. This is the place where I was born.

A. Noun clause, in apposition to "place"
B. Adjective clause, qualifying "place"
C. Noun clause, object of "is"
D. Adverb clause modifying "place"

51. Tawina realized that the boys were stealing bananas.

A. Adverb clause, modifying "realized"
B. Noun clause, compliment of "realized"
C. Adjective clause, qualifying "Tawina"
D. Noun clause, object of "realzed"

52. The difficult thing is that both of us want the ticket.

A. Noun clause, object of "is"
B. Noun clause, compliment of "is"
C. Adjective clause, qualifying "thing"
D. Adverb clause, modifying "is"

53. Since there were no seats, we had to stand.

A. Noun clause, subject of "had to stand"
B. Adverb clause, modifying "had"
C. Noun clause, subject of "had to stand"
D. Adverb clause, modifying "had to stand"

END OF QUESTION PAPER

NB: This paper contains 11 printed pages